GARDEN CITY CHURCH

Garden City Church
Live the life. Tell the story

SOCIAL MEDIA MANUAL

Garden City Church
www.gardencitychurch.net

Version 1.1

WELCOME

We are excited to have you join our volunteer team here at Garden City Church. Your commitment and service are vital to our mission, and we are committed to your growth and success, no matter your role. We pray that you will grow in your faith and find joy in serving God and our community.

Thank you for your dedication and service. Together, we can make significant impact for the Kingdom of God!

Sincerely,

Pastor Aaron Rios



INTRODUCTION

An organization’s online presence is the primary route by which the public learn and understand one’s identity, values, mission, and information. Therefore, it is imperative that our online presence accurately represents not only our Christian identity, but also Garden City’s specific mission, vision, and values.

MISSION AND VISION

Mission: To know Christ and make Him known in our city and in every nation.
And he said to them, “Go into all the world and proclaim the gospel to the whole creation. Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved, but whoever does not believe will be condemned. - Mark 16:15-16

Vision: Live the life. Tell the story.
Live the Life speaks to the internal work of God's Holy Spirit in the hearts and lives of God's Children. “*Do you not know that you are God's temple and that God's Spirit dwells in you?” - 1 Corinthians 3:16*

Tell the story speaks to the external work - sometimes called "evangelism." God does a great work in the hearts of His Children, and we have been called to share the story of Jesus with every living creature.

OUR VALUES

BIBLICALLY GROUNDED

The Bible is our ultimate authority, serving as our manual and foundation. We believe in the dependability and truthfulness of the Word of God, evidenced by personal testimony and historical data. Over the course of 1,500+ years, the Bible has been canonized and preserved, with more evidence for its authenticity than any other literature in antiquity. The Bible reveals God’s truth to humanity and teaches us the path to salvation.

COMMUNITY DRIVEN

Inspired by Matthew 25:31-46, we prioritize serving and caring for one another, recognizing that our actions towards fellow believers reflect our commitment to Christ. By equipping our community, we can extend our support and ministry, enabling believers to participate fully in the mission of the church - reaching the ends of the world.

MISSION & EVANGELISM ORIENTED

Our mission is to make disciples of all nations, baptizing them and teaching them to obey Christ’s commands (Matthew 28:19-20, Mark 16:15-16). We recognize evangelism as a fundamental responsibility of every believer, and endeavor to share the message of Christ with others.

PENTECOSTAL/ HOLY SPIRIT EMPOWERED

We embrace the power of the Holy Spirit in balance and order, as demonstrated in the Bible. Acts 2 dem-

-onstrates the early church experiencing supernatural manifestations such as healing, deliverance, and bold proclamations of the Word, and we believe that is still relevant for today’s church. Our community is committed to welcoming the gifts of the Spirit and passionately pursuing God’s agenda. We strive to maintain an environment aligned with the activities and approval of the Holy Spirit.

RELATIONALLY NURTURING

Rooted in 1 John 4:7-8, we emphasize the importance of love within our community, understanding that our health as a church is directly linked to our ability to love one another.

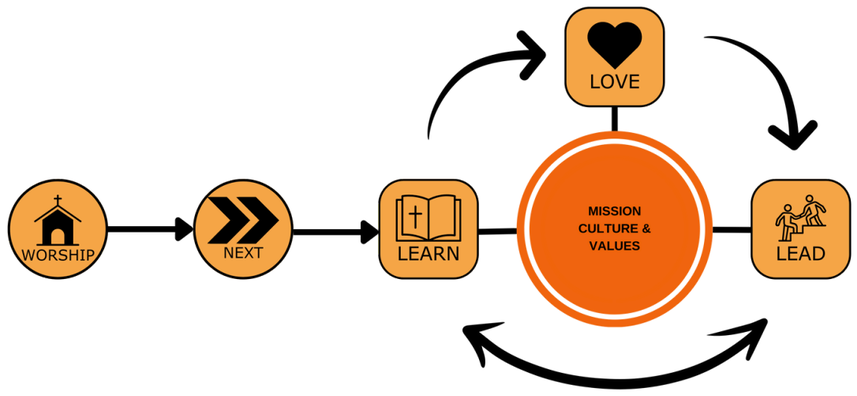
GENEROUS

Ephesians 2:4-10 reminds us of God’s generosity towards us, motivating us to be generous in return. Generosity is both an act of obedience to God and a means through which the mission of the church is accomplished (Proverbs 11:25, Matthew 10:8, Luke 6:38).

PURSUING EXCELLENCE

By the grace of God, we seek to grow in our continual pursuit of a higher standard in all aspects of our lives, as exemplified throughout Scripture (2 Corinthians 8, Ephesians 4:1-3, 2 Timothy 2:15, Colossians 3:23-24).

DISCIPLESHIP PROCESS MODEL



WORSHIP

Whether you join us for a weekend service or a Tuesday prayer night, the initial stage of our process is centered on worship. Worship forms the core of our regular gatherings, whether it's our two Sunday morning services or our Tuesday evening prayer session. During our weekend gatherings, we participate in worship, partake in monthly communion, and engage in Bible teaching that caters to both those who are curious about Christianity and those who have been longtime believers.

Additionally, throughout the year, we organize special Worship Nights aimed at involving our community and extending a warm invitation to visit our church. While your journey with us begins with worship, we strongly encourage you to take further steps towards becoming more deeply connected within our church community.

NEXT

Following your attendance at our weekend services, you might find yourself curious about our church—our beliefs, the roles of our team members, and our journey. That's why, on the **LAST Monday** of each month, we organize a dedicated class tailored for newcomers like yourself to delve deeper into who we call NEXT NIGHT.

During this one evening session, our team will guide you through a campus tour, providing insights into the various ministry opportunities available. You'll also have the chance to hear first-hand testimonies from our pastor and team members, gaining an understanding of our church's history and vision. Additionally, we'll allocate time for you to ask any questions you may have and to connect with our team members on a personal level.

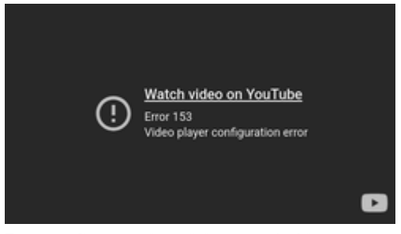
PHOTOGRAPHY TRAINING

PHOTOGRAPHY BASICS

- Rule of thirds
- Types of portraits - bust, waist and up, full-body
- You're not a surgeon - don't cut off fingers, feet, shoulders, elbows
- In the crowd, not crowded - make sure there is enough space around your subject that you do not feel visually crowded
- Perspective tells the same story a fresh way - switch it up, get creative!

PRINCIPLES OF CHURCH PHOTOGRAPHY

- **Be mindful to not interfere with people's worship experience**. While we desire to capture a powerful or intimate moment, we want to be cautious to not ruin it with our or the camera's presence. A simple solution can include anticipating those moments and switching to a lens that allows for greater distance between you and the subject. Also, for this reason, **we do not take pictures of first-time guests**, as they may feel uncomfortable with having their picture taken during their first experience.
- **All forms of media and photos are the sole property of Garden City and are not for individual use and distribution**. Should people request said photos, you can direct them to our social media accounts and website where they can screenshot them.
- **We do not publish photos of children under the age of 13** that reveal their face without express permission from their parents and/or guardians. If you are requested to delete a photo, immediately do so.
- **Do not show photos that have not been edited and published.**
- **Be ready for questions** - if people ask about the purpose of the photos, share that they are for the sake of our social media, updating our website, and graphic design.



For your first step in training, watch this:

TEAM TOOLBOX

ALL ROLES

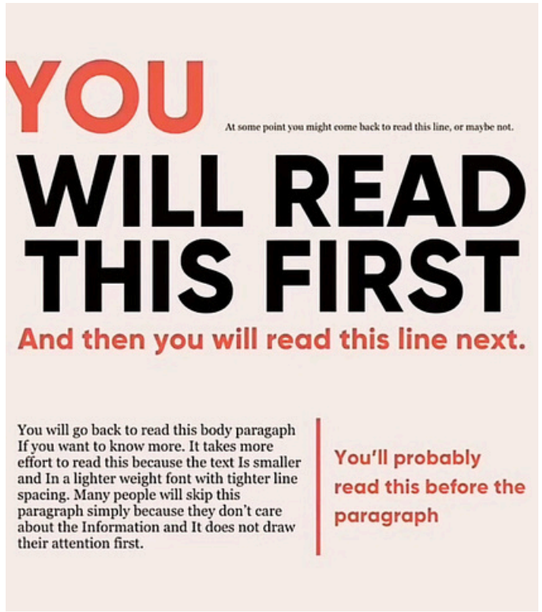
Planning Center Services
Canva
Google Drive Folders

CONTENT CREATORS	GRAPHIC DESIGNERS	PHOTOGRAPHERS
CapCut B-Roll ➜ pexels.com	Free B-roll ➜ pexels.com Free High Quality Stock Images ➜ Unsplash.com Fonts (rarely use) - Dafont.com - can download fonts	Lightroom Nikon Manual

GRAPHIC DESIGNER TRAINING

GUIDELINES FOR GREAT GRAPHICS

- Never use more than 2 different fonts (rare exceptions of 3)
- Your most important info should be the first text your eye catches (an event name is more important than the date, the date is slightly more important than the location, etc)
- Taking visual breaks can be important to refresh what catches your eye
- Don’t overwhelm people with info - if necessary direct them to where they can get additional information.
- Keep your audience in mind - will this appeal to the audience I am trying to reach?
- Keep your values and message in mind - does what I’ve created align?
- ***We’re looking for excellence, not perfection*** - don’t get caught up in the rabbit hole of working on 1 post for 6 hours.



LEARN

We strongly encourage you to prioritize your personal growth in your relationship with God. To assist you on this journey, we have developed two courses tailored to help you become a disciple of Jesus.

The first course, **FOLLOWING JESUS,** is an 8-week program designed to impart foundational Christian beliefs. Through this course, you'll gain practical insights into why we hold certain beliefs and why we engage in specific practices at Garden City Church. Upon completion of Following Jesus, we offer another course called **TRUTH-TREK.** This ongoing annual program is crafted to deepen your understanding of God's Word, ultimately equipping you to effectively disciple others and fulfill the Great Commission. We trust that these courses will support and enrich your walk with Jesus.

Furthermore, during our Sunday **DISCIPLESHIP HOUR** we provide classes that foster fellowship and facilitate a closer sense of community. Additionally, we offer various specialized courses designed to address specific needs, such as grief support through our **GRIEFSHARE** program. We invite you to take advantage of these opportunities as you continue to grow in your faith journey.

LOVE

We believe LOVE is best demonstrated in community. We aim for you to connect with fellow Christ-followers and immerse yourself in community life. Striving to live out the Christian walk in isolation leaves us vulnerable to spiritual attack and susceptible to deception. Hence, we endeavor to cultivate an environment within our **CORE GROUPS** where genuine friendships and authentic fellowship thrive.

In our **CORE GROUPS**, we advocate for transparent living, offering a safe space for individuals to openly share their struggles, failures, and inconsistencies. These groups form the cornerstone of our church community, comprising members from diverse life stages and age groups. We firmly believe that everyone, regardless of age or marital status, has valuable insights to offer, and we can all learn from one another.

Our CORE Groups gather at various times throughout the week, and some even offer childcare services. With this flexibility, we are confident that you will find a CORE Group that aligns with your schedule and needs. Join us as we journey together in faith, supporting and uplifting one another along the way.

LEAD

We believe that leading in the church is synonymous with serving (Philippians 2:7). Engaging in service is fundamental to the life of every believer, and at our church, we offer numerous opportunities for involvement. Serving our church community comes in various forms, whether it's brewing coffee as part of our Hospitality Team, warmly welcoming and assisting guests through our Landing Team, or nurturing young minds in our children's ministry. Our ministries serve as places that are intended for you to not only participate, but to continue growing while partnering with others who are on their faith journeys.

Furthermore, we are continually exploring innovative ways to extend our service to the local community through initiatives such as Vacation Bible School and our Annual "Backpack Giveaway" event. Our commitment to missions goes beyond mere financial support; we maintain active connections with missionaries in the field through our growing missions department. We engage in missionary work both locally and globally, reaching out to different parts of the world with the message of Christ's love.

Through our acts of service, we embody Christ's love and effectively draw people closer to Him. This is how the gospel is shared and embraced within our community and beyond. We pray that you discover the perfect place for you to serve and make a meaningful impact.

PURPOSE OF SOCIAL MEDIA

Social media serves multiple purposes within the church. Below are a few primary purposes, though this list is not exhaustive:

- **Evangelism**
  - Social platforms provide a unique opportunity to make the Gospel global, and can be an effective tool for Gospel witness and presence, particularly in areas of the world where it is not accessible otherwise.
- **Fostering Community**
  - Online platforms create space for our in-person community to remain connected throughout the week, as well as a space for an online community to be built.
- **Sharing Information**
  - Events and important updates can be easily and quickly shared to our existing community as well as the general public.
- **Engaging Culture**
  - Paul's approach to ministry was to "become all things to all people," (1 Corinthians 9:22-23), adapting to different contexts to share the gospel. Similarly, using social media can help the church engage with culture and communicate in ways that resonate with people today.
- **Welcoming Newcomers**
  - Before visiting a church, newcomers most often first visit a church's website and social media. As its window into the life and identity of a church, social media can prepare a hesitant viewer to walk in the front door.

Our primary goal of social media is to present ourselves to potential first-time guests and direct them to our website.



POSTING SCHEDULE

Consistent posting min 2x a week - variety of reels, posts, stories, etc.
Building story highlights - discipleship walkthrough process
Building Monthly content calendar - use of content scheduling software, launching social media campaigns, and running ads.
Evolving social media strategy that remains culturally relevant

Serving on this team is an opportunity to discover, develop, and deploy your unique communication skills, technical skills, and creativity to glorify God and build up the body of Christ.

GRAPHIC DESIGNER

The graphic designer works closely with the Social Media team leader and designs graphics for announcements, sermon graphics, and social media posts. All content is to be shared and approved first by the team leader before sharing. These tasks are both weekly and as-needed.

WEEKLY TASKS

- Create sermon graphics for weekly sermon by Saturday
  - Sermon title, theme, and notes will be shared by team leader
  - 2 Versions are needed - 1 for our main service, 1 for our YouTube page.
- Share graphics (inside Canva) with social media team leader
- Create general graphic weekly for social media by Wednesday - use your creative freedom; share with team leader

AS-NEEDED TASKS

- Announcement graphics (both 3:3 and 16:9)
- Additonal social media graphics promoting the event

TEAM ROLES AND DESCRIPTIONS

PHOTOGRAPHER

PROCEDURE

- Arrive 15-20 mins before service/event
- Turn on and adjusting camera settings appropriately
- Take photos/video before, during, and after event, with the photography checklist as a guide
- Turn off camera, ensure all lens caps are on, and set up battery to charge
- Sort and transfer all files immediately after event to hard drive or Lightroom - delete files off of SD card after they have been transferred.
- Edit photos

PHOTOGRAPHY CHECKLIST

Each Sunday, we strive to capture...

- 3-5 Quality* pictures of worship/prayer
- 3-5 Quality pictures of speaker (horizontal)
- 1-2 Quality pictures of any additional speaker (giving announcements, communion, etc.)
- 5-8 Quality pictures of community fellowship (before and after services)
    - People talking
    - People praying for each other
    - People serving in ministry roles

During special events, we capture...

- Key identifying elements - whatever elements makes that event unique
- Whole experience - photos of the whole crowd, as well as smaller clusters of people.

*This is not the number of photos taken, but out of the photos we take, we aim for this many quality ones *(well composed, in focus, able to be used).*

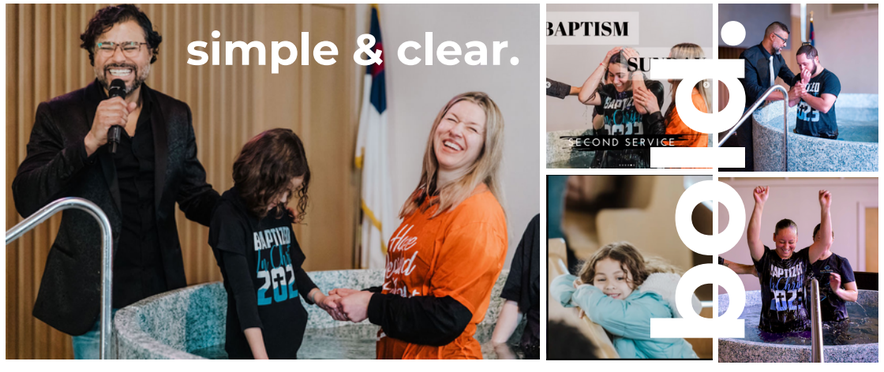
CONTENT CREATOR

The content creator weekly creates and edits both photos and video footage for the sake of social media posts, and collaborates with the team about content strategies and creative expressions of our brand.

PROCEDURE

- Set up camera on tripod and record video footage of the Sunday sermon
- Receives footage via the social media team leader - by Sunday evening
- Creates 1 sermon reel by Monday evening, and 1 by Wednesday evening
- Attends all meetings and arrives with creative ideas to implement for social media

BRAND VOICE AND CONTENT GUIDELINES



bold | energetic | dramatic | modern | neutral

SOCIAL MEDIA CONTENT GUIDELINES

- Garden City does not involve itself in political conversations, social movements, or theological debates online. Controversial issues or events are not to be used as hooks or for humorous content.
- Keeping our primary identity and goals in view, we keep our humorous content in a smaller proportion to our Gospel-focused content.
- We ensure all of our content aligns with our principle of honoring our leaders, as they stand as the primary representatives of our community.
- Being mindful of all types and ages of audiences present online, we moderate our topics and ensure our content does not appear to diminish or demean any other person or community, even those with whom we may not agree. This does not mean we are quiet about Biblical truth *(for instance, topics of alcoholism, abuse, or homosexuality),* we ensure it is said tactfully and within proper context. ***It is imperative the full meaning of a statement within a sermon clip is explained so it cannot be twisted or misinterpreted by the public audience.***
- All music used in all types of posts should remain God-honoring. We do not use instrumental versions of inappropriate songs as background music; doing so can remind a listener of said song and associate us with it.
- Responding to Comments Online
    - Positive Comments - respond as soon as possible to positive comments; online conversation promotes our presence to a bigger audience.
    - Negative comments - we ignore negative comments but do not delete, their presence still promotes our content.

BRAND GUIDELINE

“Media can inhibit or enhance the message.” - Pr. Aaron Rios

OUR ROLE

The Social Media Dream Team functions as a hub of CREW and operates under CREW leadership, but also in collaboration with our present Media Team. In some instances, our trainings and operations may be in tandem.

WHAT IS BRANDING?

- **Definition:** A name, term, sign, symbol or design, or a combination of them intended to identify one business or organization as distinct and unique from others.
- Branding will draw people towards the values and characteristics you have presented and reinforced through your brand.
- **Your brand is your story.**
- You understand your brand when you can clearly and accurately communicate what Garden City Church is in 1-3 sentences. We are here to communicate our identity in creative avenues.
- Jesus was good at branding! He made clear His vision and purposes - who He was, and who He was not. In the same way, we must make our message clear, and redirect or remove ourselves from ideas that stray from our identity.

OBJECTIVE OF A GOOD BRAND

- Clearly communicates your identity and what needs you fill - is authentic to who you are. We are not trying to copy other churches, or be something we are not.
- Connects to your audience authentically
- Motivates the audience

SIGNS OF GOOD BRANDING

- Cohesiveness - there’s unity amongst all forms of media used
- The church/company accurately demonstrates what the brand communicates
- If you brand yourself as diverse and welcoming, you better be diverse and welcoming!
- Consistent in your touch points - you’re getting the same message no matter your point of entry (Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, website).
- Includes a call to action - our primary call to action is visiting Garden City in person or our website.

TERMS TO KNOW

- **JPG** - images with no background transparency
- **PNG** - images that can have background transparency
- **B-Roll** - Secondary video footage that is supplemental to your primary content and provides context and visual interest (eg - footage person walking in a field when narrator is speaking about a journey)

TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

Training and development is vital to the success of you and your team. When we stop learning, we stop growing. There are three levels of training to ensure your ministry thrives:

INITIAL TRAINING

Comprehensive training when you start your role to equip you with the necessary skills and knowledge to promote success. This includes the orientation, onboarding, and a trial time of serving in your role.

ONGOING DEVELOPMENT

Regular training sessions, workshops, goal setting, and feedback to ensure continuous improvement.

INITIAL TRAINING

Onboarding for those interested in joining the social media team entails going through the About Us Manual and individual job descriptions of each role, then a 90-day trial period.

ONBOARDING TIMELINE

Weeks 1-4: Training & Shadowing (I do)

- Clear start date and end date to the process is agreed upon
- The team leader or trusted team member conducts an initial training in the specific role *(video editing, creating reels, photography, graphic design)*.
- Recruits are paired with an experienced team member to shadow and receive on-the-job training.

Weeks 5-8: Hands-On Practice (We Do)

- The recruit serves alongside their paired team member, while receiving direction, feedback, and support as needed.

Weeks 10-12: Taking the Reigns (You Do)

- The recruit is placed on schedule to serve while the paired team member shadows and observes, but does not intervene.

OFFICIAL EVALUATION

An official evaluation is held with the team leader to assess and reflect on one’s experience and determine if they would like to continue or explore other opportunities. If the position is found to be a good fit for both the volunteer and team leader, an official covenant will be signed to make the recruit an official team member.

ONGOING TRAINING

All team members are expected to attend training opportunities when they are presented. This could come in the form of in-person trainings, online courses, or materials presented to the team. For the team to grow in excellence as a whole, it is essential that each member’s skill set develops, so the whole team does not rely on one or two experts.